

FACHABITURPRÜFUNG 2024

zum Erwerb der Fachhochschulreife
an Fachoberschulen und Berufsoberschulen

ENGLISCH

Freitag, 17. Mai 2024

READING COMPREHENSION TEXTS

Diese Prüfung besteht aus zwei Teilen:

READING: Tasks I - III (9:00 - 10:30 Uhr)

Pause von 30 Minuten

WRITING: Material-Based Writing (60 Minuten)

Im **READING**-Teil werden Texte und Aufgaben in zwei getrennten Geheften vorgelegt.

Die Aufgaben (**TASKS**) liegen in zwei Varianten (**V1** und **V2**) vor.

Diese sind gemischt auszugeben.

Alle Lösungen sind von den Prüflingen im Aufgabengeheft einzutragen.

In der Pause werden die Text- und Aufgabengehefte von den Arbeitsplätzen der Schüler entfernt.

Der **WRITING**-Teil wird erst nach der Pause ausgegeben.

Hilfsmittel: Ein einsprachiges Wörterbuch (ggf. auch inkl. Writing Tutor)

Reading Text I: Number Eight Daughter

The following text by Jeannie Tseng is the beginning of a short story set in Asia.

I'm ugly because when I was a baby, no one cared enough to wipe the raindrops off my face. That's how Mother Kang explained it to me, but who can trust a woman ruled by her superstitions? It had rained furiously the day the Kang family took me in as their future daughter-in-law. Their youngest son, Jin Lok, was only a toddler and I was an infant, but it wasn't unusual
5 in those days for a well-established family to take in an unwanted girl, raising her as their own, training her to cook and clean under the strict eye of the family matriarch. The son was then guaranteed a pure and dutiful wife who knew her place, and the family gained a servant who required no payment beyond simple food, a cot for sleeping, and the promise of marriage.

By giving me to the Kangs, my birth family had rid themselves of the burden of an extra mouth
10 to feed, especially one that belonged to a useless girl. I was the eighth child in a family of ten, and **although eight is a lucky number, that wasn't the case for me.** My parents were illiterate and put no thought into naming me: they called me Bat Moi – Eight Daughter – and this never changed, even after I was given to the Kangs.

Old Cook once told me that Father Kang had seen my birth mother carrying me on her back when
15 she went around to collect the night soil. He'd been smitten by my round apple cheeks and bright black eyes, and since they had no daughter of their own, he persuaded his wife to strike a bargain. My birth family received two bolts of cotton and an old steel wok in exchange for me and the promise that they would never try to claim me again. I think Old Cook told me the story to make the point that sacrifices had been made on my behalf (she had loved that old wok), and that I
20 was luckier than I realized.

I remember very little from my early days, only that I lived in fear of Mother Kang, who had a sharp tongue and an even sharper switch. Father Kang was almost never around, but when he was, he put small slices of pork on my plate, or tweaked my braid if I was serving him his hot tea and sunflower seeds. One time he came home after many days away and brought me a candy in
25 the shape of a little fish. I treasured that sweet, taking one lick every night before I went to sleep. I hid the fish inside my bedroll until one day when it was very hot, I discovered it had melted into the straw bedding. I hid my tears, but Mother Kang caught me licking the sweet stickiness off the bedroll and whipped my shins until they resembled raw meat. After that, all candy tasted sour.

Because her husband favored me, Mother Kang treated me no better than the other servant girl
30 in the house. Ah Chiao walked with a limp and was the same age as Jin Lok, but no one suggested that she should be his wife. Next to Old Cook, Ah Chiao was the closest thing I had to a friend in that house. The Kang house was magnificent, with a large central courtyard that contained an outdoor kitchen and an open-air well; behind the kitchen was a sheltered pantry where Ah Chiao and I slept at night, on canvas cots that could be folded up during the daytime. From an early

35 age, I was trained to take care of that house and its inhabitants with absolute faithfulness and diligence, no matter the circumstances.

It was a sultry morning, the air already thick with kitchen smoke and the fetid fumes from the outhouse. I had swept the courtyard, washed and chopped the vegetables, and cooked the rice porridge, all before Old Cook arrived. Although I was younger than Jin Lok, it was my job to wake
40 and prepare him for the day, usually for lessons with his tutor. I would help wash Jin Lok's face and dress him in the clothes I'd laundered the previous day. Waking him was one of my favorite tasks.

Jin Lok had delicate facial features, with sculpted cheekbones and a high bridge on his nose that was the envy of all – he was the closest thing I had to beauty. Every night, I rubbed rendered
45 sheep fat into his hands to keep them supple, so that he could wield his ink brush with sensitivity and control. He often told me that his calligraphy was praised for its balance and strength, evidence of his fine character and moral rectitude. It must have been odd for him to feel the raised calluses of my hands against his soft skin, but he accepted me without complaint.

Jin Lok wasn't brash and robust like his older brother, Jin Yu, and I felt fortunate to have been
50 promised to the younger son. Mother Kang often bragged that Jin Yu had a head for business, while Jin Lok was destined to be a scholar, or better yet, a government official. No one dared contradict Mother Kang's assessment of her two sons, but Old Cook and Ah Chiao often gossiped about Jin Yu's gambling debts and bad business dealings. [...]

Reading Text II: For The Love Of Nature

(A) It's been years now that Hilary Hutcheson has known her rivers were changing. When she first started guiding in northern Montana, there were at least 50 glaciers melting into the waterways of Glacier National Park, she says. Today, there are only half that many, and the rivers where she fly-fishes are warmer and shallower.

5 (B) Many days during her season, the state imposes what are called "hoot owl" restrictions, which require fishers to be off the water by 2 p.m. if river temperatures have risen to 73 degrees Fahrenheit for three consecutive days. The goal is to avoid adding even more stress on trout and other river species who are already struggling with water temperatures well above their natural comfort levels. Hoot owl is an economic burden on guides like Ms. Hutcheson. But those involved
10 in the fisheries – from her conservative neighbors to the politically diverse customers at her fly shop to other staunchly independent guides like her – realize the rule is also essential to protect their ecosystems in the face of a changing climate. "In the fly-fishing industry, what I see, and what I hear, is that the climate crisis is not just a fact but a definite moving point for us," she says. Rallying around climate action "is not an ostracizing thing in our communities. It shows that you
15 care about fisheries, and that's it."

(C) That sentiment is increasingly widespread among people who work and play outside. To kayakers like Adam Cramer, CEO of the nonprofit group Outdoor Alliance, who has witnessed climate-forced changes in his rivers; to businesspeople like former Sugarbush ski resort owner and Merrill Lynch executive Win Smith, who has watched Vermont winters become increasingly
20 erratic; and to hunters, mountain bikers, and snowboarders who are noticing changes to their beloved landscapes, climate change has become less of a partisan issue and more of a rallying cry that **MC 2**.

(D) And gradually, say some advocates and lawmakers, this broad coalition of outdoorspeople is convincing their representatives in Washington and in statehouses across the country to treat it the same way. "The outdoors is a way to open up conversation about climate", says Lindsay Bourgoine, the vice president of programs at Protect Our Winters, a climate advocacy organization founded by snowboarder Jeremy Jones in 2007 that promotes a "cross-partisan" approach to climate change. "It's a way to talk about common ground," Ms. Bourgoine adds. While few expect wholehearted, bipartisan agreement on global warming – about either causes
30 or solutions – many say the debate around climate change has made a marked turn from focusing on whether it exists to how to deal with it, and how fast.

(E) That includes questions about the role of proposed technical solutions. In general, Democrats prefer behavior changes as well as a rapid movement toward replacing fossil fuels with zero-carbon energy sources. Most Republicans favor solutions that tap next-generation technologies, and insist on transitioning more slowly from fossil fuels. But to many outdoorspeople, these
35 details matter less than the fact that politicians are focusing on climate in the first place.

(F) Last spring as the Democrat-controlled Congress was weighing major climate legislation, Olympic cross-country skier and Protect Our Winters ambassador Jessie Diggins met with a new caucus of conservative lawmakers interested in shaping climate solutions. Ms. Diggins is the most successful U.S. Nordic skier in history. From her first medal at the World Championships a decade ago to her Olympic gold in 2018 to her individual gold at Worlds this year – all firsts for America – she has used her growing platform to speak out on climate change. “I know that looking for bipartisan solutions is tricky and can be frustrating, and conditions are not perfect,” Ms. Diggins told the group. “But all we’re asking is to show up and get to that finish line knowing that you really have done your best.” Ms. Diggins has made multiple lobbying trips to Washington over the past five years, often with other athletes. Winter athletes, Ms. Diggins has said, are the canaries in the coal mine when it comes to climate change. She and other top racers are increasingly finding themselves racing on ribbons of manufactured snow in a warming Europe. They stride through slush against a backdrop of green grass, or glide past Alpine vistas in cutoff Lycra tights to cope with temperatures well into the 50s Fahrenheit.

(G) “We see climate change happening all over the world, and it affects everyone at every level,” she said. “I see man-made snow everywhere we go – nobody can count on natural snow anymore. It’s a sign we really need to do something. Climate change is taking away a very healthy, incredibly fun, family-oriented sport that I love.” Ms. Diggins says she recognizes that there isn’t always agreement across party lines on how to solve the climate crisis. But she was heartened that the conservative caucus acknowledged that it was a problem caused by humans and seemed invested in addressing it when she talked with them in Washington, she says. For her part, Ms. Hutcheson decided years ago that part of her job as a river guide was to talk to her guests about climate. “When they come out with me, it’s a natural progression to become a climate activist,” she says. “You can’t enjoy it and take it and feel good about the taking without giving anything back. Most people leave and think, ‘What can I do? What is my role and responsibility here?’” That’s true, she says, across the political spectrum. “It’s not like there’s an outdoors for Democrats and an outdoors for Republicans,” she adds.

Reading Text III: Is There Life After Influencing?

(A) At her first full-time job since leaving influencing, the erstwhile smoothie-bowl virtuoso Lee Tilghman stunned a new co-worker with her enthusiasm for the 9-to-5 grind. She had once had what he wanted: flexible hours, no boss, a devoted audience so rabid for her recommendations that she could command as much as \$20,000 for a single branded Instagram post on her 400,000-follower account, @LeeFromAmerica. The co-worker pulled her aside that first morning, wanting to impress upon her the stakes of that decision. "This is terrible," he told her. "Like, I'm at a desk." "You don't get it," Ms. Tilghman remembered saying. "You think you're a slave, but you're not." He had it backward, she added. "When you're an influencer, then you have chains on."

(B) In the late 2010s, for a certain subset of millennial women, Ms. Tilghman was wellness culture, a warm-blooded mood board of workout sets, coconut oil and headstands. She had earned north of \$300,000 a year — and then dropped more than 150,000 followers, her entire management team, and most of her savings to become an I.R.L.¹ person. The corporate gig, as a social media director for a tech platform, was a revelation. "I could just show up to work and do work," Ms. Tilghman said. After she was done, she could leave. She didn't have to be a brand. There's no comments section at an office job.

(C) Ms. Tilghman, 33, recalled the encounter last month during an online workshop she held to guide other creators through the process of leaving influencing. The existence of the workshop indicates a new disillusionment on the part of even the most prominent content creators. For more than a decade, social media has carried with it the implicit promise that with some combination of luck and incessant posting, a user with no connections, no experience, and sometimes no discernible skill can become rich and famous. In 2019, a Morning Consult report found that 54 percent of Gen Z and millennial Americans were interested in becoming influencers.

(D) But the dream comes with its own costs. If social media has made audiences anxious, it's driving creators to the brink. In 2021, Erin Kern announced to her 600,000 Instagram followers that she would be deactivating her account; she had been losing her hair, and her doctors blamed work-induced stress. And hers was only the kind of ambivalence that made news. Other influencers faded without fanfare — teens whose mental health had taken too much of a hit, and amateur influencers who stopped posting after an algorithm tweak tanked the number of clicks they got. Some had been at this for a decade or more, starting at 12 or 14 or 19.

(E) Casey Lewis, who helms a newsletter about Gen Z consumer trends, predicts more pivots and exits. TikTok has elevated creators faster than other platforms and burned them out quicker, she said. Ms. Lewis expects a swell of former influencers taking jobs with P.R. agencies, marketing firms and product development conglomerates. She pointed out that creators have experience

¹ I.R.L. = in real life

35 not just in video and photo editing, but in image management, crisis communication and rapid response. “MC 2,” she said.

(F) For Lee Tilghman, the process of leaving influencing began after the apex of her social media success in 2018. Ms. Tilghman then experienced some tough years: Her obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD) flared up. She felt paranoid and was afraid to leave her apartment. “That was the
40 beginning of thinking, ‘I’ve had enough of this,’” she said. She came to realize that she did not want to perform her life for content. Even when she was laid off from the tech job in October 2021, she resisted the urge to post through it.

(G) Now, at the workshop, she was firm with the attendees that this would not be a seminar about “de-influencing,” the new buzzword that describes influencers who tell their followers
45 what’s not worth their cash. Nor was it about mental health influencing. It was intended to be a practical workshop, with a section on how to write a résumé that best frames influencer experience, and another on how to network. “For people who are here who want to learn how to be an influencer, but with balance, I don’t have tips,” she said. “For me, I couldn’t.” She has forsworn merch. She will not partner with an incense brand. What she wants is to reset her
50 relationship with the internet. It’s not monkish abstinence she’s after, but simple coexistence. She wants to use social media like a regular person.

(H) After Ms. Tilghman’s workshop, criticism mushroomed in the comments. She saw a tweet that summed up the negative sentiment. It read, in part: “influencers offering workshop to teach people how to stop being influencers while being an influencer for not influencing.” “I thought,
55 ‘This person doesn’t get it,’” she said. She resented the idea that the workshop was a cash grab; she wasn’t going to get rich off a few hundred bucks in ticket sales. She hasn’t ruled out more events like the workshop; she has also met one-on-one with other influencers for an added fee, helping them chart their own escape routes. But mostly, she wants a job again — a boring job. “Put that in the article,” Ms. Tilghman deadpanned. She knows good exposure when she sees it.